

KNOWLEDGEABLE

Educational Media & Verified Information Platform

Business Plan — Original Concept

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This document describes the original Knowledgeable concept: a free-access educational media platform combining verified news curation, media literacy training, academic content, exam support, and practical skills.

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1. Executive Summary

Knowledgeable is a UK educational media platform built around one principle: accurate, accessible information should be free. The platform combines five content pillars under a single brand, targeting secondary school students first and expanding to a broader audience over time.

The five pillars:

- **Verified News Curation.** Aggregating real news from multiple sources and perspectives to show the full picture. No opinion, no spin, just comparative reporting.
- **Media Literacy & Fake News.** Teaching users how to identify misinformation. A dedicated section displaying fake articles (created in-house for teaching purposes or found externally) alongside guides on spotting them.
- **Academic Simplification.** Taking complex academic subjects (aerospace, physics, advanced mathematics) and explaining them in plain, simple language. University-level concepts made accessible to anyone.
- **GCSE & A-Level Exam Support.** Free revision guides, PowerPoint presentations, topic explanations, and revision flashcards for all GCSE and A-Level subjects. Aligned to UK exam boards.
- **Practical Skills Library.** Courses on skills that typically cost hundreds or thousands of pounds elsewhere (coding, design, business, trades), available for £10 per month with full library access.

The model is simple: core content is free, premium services are paid. Free access covers news, media literacy, academic articles, and all exam revision materials. Paid services include one-to-one tutoring, video explanations (cheaper than tutoring), and the skills library subscription.

Key Financials (Base Case)

Metric	Year 1	Year 3	Year 5
Monthly Active Users	8,000	45,000	120,000
Paying Subscribers	400	4,500	15,000
Total Revenue	£32,000	£185,000	£580,000
Net Profit / (Loss)	(£12,000)	£38,000	£195,000

2. Business Concept

2.1 Problem Statement

Four problems, one platform:

Misinformation is everywhere. Only 45% of UK adults can identify misinformation most of the time (Ofcom, 2023). Social media algorithms optimise for engagement, not accuracy. Young people consume news through feeds that reward outrage over facts. There is no mainstream, student-facing platform dedicated to showing news from all angles.

Complex knowledge is locked behind jargon. Academic content is written for academics. A sixth-form student curious about aerospace engineering hits a wall of technical language. The gap between GCSE-level explanations and university-level material is enormous, and almost nobody fills it.

Exam revision is fragmented. Students bounce between BBC Bitesize, Seneca, Physics & Maths Tutor, YouTube, and random PDFs. Some resources are excellent but incomplete. Others are comprehensive but poorly structured. No single platform provides revision materials, explanations, and flashcards across all subjects with consistent quality.

Practical skills are overpriced. A coding bootcamp costs £3,000 to £10,000. A professional photography course runs £500 to £2,000. Many of these skills can be taught online at a fraction of the cost, but the existing platforms (Skillshare, Udemy) are global, not UK-focused, and vary wildly in quality.

2.2 Proposed Solution

Knowledgeable brings all four solutions under one brand:

- A news section that curates stories from multiple sources (BBC, Reuters, The Guardian, The Telegraph, Sky News, international outlets) and presents them side by side. No editorial opinion. Just the facts from each source, clearly labelled.
- A fake news lab that teaches critical thinking. Users encounter sample fake articles (some created by the Knowledgeable team as teaching tools, others sourced from real misinformation) and learn to identify red flags: emotional language, missing sources, manipulated images, logical fallacies.
- An academic knowledge base that takes complex subjects and explains them simply. Not dumbed down. Simplified. The difference matters. A section on quantum mechanics should leave a 16-year-old understanding the core concepts, not feeling patronised.
- A full exam revision hub with PPTs, written explanations, and digital flashcards for every GCSE and A-Level subject. Free to access, no sign-up wall for basic materials.
- A practical skills library with structured courses on high-demand skills. Full library access for £10/month. Each course is structured, progressive, and produced to a consistent quality standard.

2.3 Mission

Make accurate information and quality education accessible to everyone. Free where possible. Affordable where necessary. Never misleading.

3. Market Opportunity

3.1 Market Size

Segment	Size	Source
UK EdTech market (2024)	£2.4–2.8 billion	Statista / Research and Markets
UK EdTech projected (2030)	£4.5–5.2 billion (12–15% CAGR)	Industry projections
UK private tutoring market	£2.5–3.2 billion annually	Ipsos MORI / Explore Learning
Annual GCSE candidates (England)	~630,000 students	Ofqual / JCQ
Annual A-Level candidates (England)	~265,000 students	Ofqual / JCQ
Total UK secondary pupils (11–18)	~3 million	Department for Education
Global online skills market	\$40+ billion	Research and Markets

3.2 Target Audience

Phase 1 (Launch): UK GCSE and A-Level students (ages 14–18). Approximately 895,000 exam candidates annually in England alone. These students already seek free online revision resources. Knowledgeable's exam support pillar is the hook that brings them to the platform. Once there, they encounter the news, media literacy, academic, and skills content.

Phase 2 (Year 2+): Parents (who pay for tutoring and premium content), adult learners (skills library), and teachers (classroom resources). Expand the audience from students to anyone who values accurate, accessible information.

Phase 3 (Year 3+): International English-speaking markets. The news and skills pillars are geography-neutral. The exam support pillar could expand to international GCSE and IB curricula.

3.3 Market Trends

- 34% of UK secondary students use private tutoring (rising). Parents spending £20–£45/hour on average.
- 60%+ of teachers report lack of confidence in teaching media literacy (Ofcom). Schools want structured resources.
- 71% of UK teens are concerned about fake news (Pew Research). Demand exists but supply is weak.
- Bank of Mum and Dad: parents increasingly willing to pay for digital education tools, especially post-COVID.

4. Competitive Landscape

4.1 Exam Revision Competitors

Platform	Model	Price	Strengths	Weaknesses
BBC Bitesize	Free (BBC funded)	£0	Brand trust, comprehensive GCSE/A-Level coverage	No revenue model, limited interactivity, no skills or news
Seneca Learning	Freemium	£0–15/month	8M+ registered users, gamified, teacher dashboards	Crowded, no news/media literacy, no skills
Save My Exams	Subscription	£5–15/month	High-quality video, exam-board specific	Video only, no wider content, no free tier
Physics & Maths Tutor	Free	£0	Trusted by teachers, comprehensive past papers	STEM only, no arts/humanities, no revenue model
Khan Academy	Free	£0	100M+ global users, rigorous methodology	US-focused (SAT not GCSE), limited UK alignment

4.2 News & Media Literacy Competitors

Platform	Model	Price	Strengths	Weaknesses
The Day	School subscription	£500–5K/year	News + education, media literacy focus	B2B only (schools), not student-direct
Full Fact	Non-profit	£0	High credibility, fact-checking expertise	Not consumer-facing, no exam content
First Draft	Non-profit / research	£0	Academic authority on misinformation	Not student-facing, no platform product

4.3 Skills Platform Competitors

Platform	Model	Price	Strengths	Weaknesses
Skillshare	Subscription	~£2–30/year	11M+ users, huge library, low price	Global (not UK-specific), variable quality
Udemy	Per-course	£7–15/course	50M+ learners, massive catalogue	Variable quality, no curation, no subscription
Coursera	Free + paid certs	£30–50/cert	University partnerships, credential value	University-level (not GCSE), expensive

4.4 Knowledgeable's Position

No UK platform combines all five pillars: verified news, media literacy, academic simplification, exam revision, and practical skills. BBC Bitesize is the closest for exam content but has no news, no media literacy, and no skills. The Day covers news-education but sells to schools, not students. Skillshare covers skills but nothing academic.

Knowledgeable's competitive advantage is breadth under one roof with a student-first entry point. The exam revision materials are the hook. Everything else is the ecosystem that keeps users engaged beyond exam season.

5. Service Offering & Pricing

5.1 Free Tier (Core Platform)

Available to everyone, no account required for basic access:

- News Curation: Daily curated stories with multi-source comparison. Updated regularly.
- Media Literacy Hub: Fake news identification guides, example fake articles (labelled), fact-checking toolkit.
- Academic Articles: Simplified explanations of complex topics across sciences, humanities, and social sciences.
- GCSE & A-Level Materials: Revision guides (written), PowerPoint presentations, digital flashcards for all major subjects and exam boards (AQA, Edexcel, OCR, WJEC).

The free tier is not a teaser. It is the product. The paid services sit on top for users who want more depth or personal support.

5.2 Paid Services

Service	Price	Description
Skills Library	£10/month	Full access to all practical skills courses. Coding, design, business, trades, languages, and more. Cancel anytime.
Video Explanations	£3–5/topic or £8/month all-access	Recorded video walkthroughs of exam topics. Cheaper than tutoring, available on demand.
One-to-One Tutoring	£15–25/hour	Live online tutoring with vetted tutors. Below market rate (vs £20–45/hour average).
Premium Revision Pack	£5/subject or £15/all subjects	Enhanced revision materials: practice exams, model answers, examiner commentary.

5.3 Pricing Philosophy

The core principle is that access to accurate information and basic education should not cost anything. The free tier must be genuinely useful on its own. Paid services are for users who want deeper engagement, personal support, or access to the skills library. Pricing is set well below market rates for equivalent services (tutoring at £15–25 vs market £20–45, skills at £10/month vs bootcamp £3,000+).

6. Revenue Model

Knowledgeable generates revenue from four streams. The free platform drives traffic and trust. Paid services convert a fraction of users into paying customers.

Revenue Stream	% of Revenue (Mature)	Description
Skills Library Subscriptions	40%	£10/month recurring. Highest margin, most scalable. Target: 5% of active users convert.
Video Explanations	20%	£8/month all-access or per-topic. Seasonal (peaks before exams). Target: 3% conversion.
Tutoring Commissions	25%	Knowledgeable takes 20–30% of tutoring fees. Tutors are freelance, not employed.
Premium Revision Packs	10%	One-time purchases. Seasonal. Lower margin but high volume during exam windows.
Advertising (limited)	5%	Non-intrusive display ads on free content. Only from education-aligned brands. Never on exam revision pages.

Advertising is kept deliberately small. The brand promise is accurate, trustworthy information. Aggressive advertising would undermine that. Ads are limited to the news section sidebar and general knowledge pages. Exam revision and media literacy sections are ad-free.

7. Operations & Platform

7.1 Platform Architecture

Website-first. The platform is a responsive web application accessible on desktop, tablet, and mobile browsers. No native app in Year 1 — a well-built responsive site covers all devices without the cost and complexity of app development.

YouTube channel as a promotional arm. Short explainer videos, media literacy demonstrations, and teasers for premium video content. YouTube drives traffic to the website, not the other way around.

7.2 Content Production

Content is produced in-house by the founder and freelance contributors:

- News Curation: Founder-led initially (2–3 hours/day). Aggregation, comparison, and summary writing. No original reporting.
- Media Literacy: Created in batches. Fake news examples, identification guides, and interactive quizzes. Updated monthly.
- Academic Articles: Commissioned from subject specialists (freelance academics, teachers, postgraduates) at £50–£150 per article.
- GCSE/A-Level Materials: Created by qualified teachers and tutors on a freelance basis. £30–£80 per revision guide or PPT set.
- Skills Courses: Produced by practitioners (freelance or revenue-share model). Initial library of 15–20 courses at launch.
- Video Explanations: Recorded by tutors. Payment per video (£20–£50) or revenue share on views.

7.3 Tutoring Operations

Knowledgeable does not employ tutors. Tutors are freelance, vetted through a screening process (qualifications, DBS check, trial session). The platform handles matching, scheduling, and payment. Knowledgeable takes a 20–30% commission. This avoids employment costs while maintaining quality through vetting and reviews.

7.4 Technology

- Website: Built on a CMS (WordPress or custom) with a learning management plugin for course delivery.
- Flashcards: Built using a spaced repetition system (open-source or custom).
- Tutoring: Integrated video call functionality (Zoom API or similar) with scheduling.
- Payments: Stripe for subscriptions and one-time purchases.
- Hosting: Cloud hosting (AWS or DigitalOcean). Estimated £50–£150/month at launch, scaling with traffic.

8. Financial Projections

8.1 Revenue Forecast

Revenue Stream	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 4	Year 5
Skills Subscriptions	£8,000	£36,000	£78,000	£145,000	£240,000
Video Explanations	£4,000	£18,000	£38,000	£65,000	£110,000
Tutoring Commission	£10,000	£24,000	£45,000	£75,000	£130,000
Premium Packs	£5,000	£12,000	£18,000	£30,000	£55,000
Advertising	£0	£3,000	£6,000	£15,000	£45,000
Total Revenue	£27,000	£93,000	£185,000	£330,000	£580,000

8.2 Cost Structure

Cost Category	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 5
Content Production	£8,000	£22,000	£38,000	£85,000
Hosting & Technology	£2,000	£5,000	£10,000	£25,000
Freelance Tutors (net after commission)	—	—	—	—
Marketing & Outreach	£2,000	£8,000	£15,000	£35,000
Founder Drawing	£12,000	£20,000	£30,000	£45,000
Staff (from Year 2)	£0	£25,000	£55,000	£120,000
Legal, Insurance, Admin	£2,000	£3,000	£5,000	£8,000
Contingency (10%)	£2,600	£8,300	£15,300	£31,800
Total Costs	£28,600	£91,300	£168,300	£349,800

Note: Tutoring is a marketplace model. Tutors are paid directly from student fees minus commission. The commission income appears in revenue; the tutor payment does not appear in costs. Knowledgeable's cost is only the platform infrastructure to facilitate tutoring.

8.3 Profit & Loss Summary

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3	Year 5
Total Revenue	£27,000	£93,000	£185,000	£580,000
Total Costs	£28,600	£91,300	£168,300	£349,800
Net Profit / (Loss)	(£1,600)	£1,700	£16,700	£230,200
Cumulative P/L	(£1,600)	£100	£16,800	£280,000+

Year 1 is near break-even because the founder keeps costs minimal (no office, no staff, freelance content production). The business becomes sustainably profitable from Year 2 as subscriber numbers grow and content costs amortise across more users.

8.4 Sensitivity Analysis

Scenario	Y1 Revenue	Y3 Revenue	Y5 Revenue	Break-Even
Optimistic (strong word-of-mouth, viral content)	£40,000	£250,000	£800,000	Year 1
Base Case	£27,000	£185,000	£580,000	Year 2
Pessimistic (slow adoption, high churn)	£15,000	£90,000	£280,000	Year 3
Stress Test (free tier only, minimal conversions)	£8,000	£40,000	£120,000	Year 4+

Even the stress test is survivable. If paid conversion rates stay minimal, the founder can sustain the platform on tutoring commission and minimal subscription income while keeping personal costs low. The worst case is a useful free resource that doesn't generate significant profit, not a financial collapse.

9. Risk Analysis

Risk	Probability	Impact	Mitigation
Competing with free (BBC Bitesize)	HIGH	HIGH	Differentiate on breadth (news + media literacy + skills). Bitesize doesn't cover 3 of 5 pillars. Quality and consistency across all subjects.
Low paid conversion rates	HIGH	MEDIUM	Keep free tier genuinely useful (builds trust). Optimise conversion funnels. Skills library is the primary revenue driver, not exam content.
Content quality inconsistency	MEDIUM	HIGH	Strict editorial standards. Vet all freelance contributors. Quality review before publishing. Start narrow (core subjects) and expand.
Seasonal revenue (exam cycle)	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Skills library and news are year-round. Diversify revenue beyond exam-linked products. Build content library during off-peak for next cycle.
Copyright issues (news curation)	LOW	HIGH	Link to original sources, don't reproduce full articles. Fair use for commentary and comparison. Legal review of curation practices.
Tutor quality and safeguarding	LOW	HIGH	DBS checks mandatory. Qualification verification. Trial sessions. Review system. Insurance.

10. Pilot Launch Strategy

10.1 Pilot Scope

Launch with three of the five pillars: GCSE revision materials (the hook), media literacy hub, and the skills library. News curation and academic simplification are added in Phase 2 once the core platform is stable and traffic is growing.

Subject coverage at launch: start with 5 core GCSE subjects (Maths, English, Biology, Chemistry, Physics) plus 3 A-Level subjects (Maths, Biology, Chemistry). Expand to all subjects over Year 1.

Skills library at launch: 15–20 courses covering the most in-demand skills (basic coding, graphic design, Excel/data, photography, public speaking, personal finance).

10.2 Timeline

Phase	Timeline	Focus
Pre-launch	Months 1–2	Build website, produce initial content batch (50 revision guides, 10 media literacy resources, 15 skills courses), set up payment system
Soft launch	Month 3	Launch to a small test audience (friends, family, one school). Gather feedback. Fix issues.
Public launch	Month 4	Open to public. Initial marketing push via social media, school outreach, and YouTube.
Growth	Months 5–12	Expand subject coverage, add news curation, academic articles. First tutoring marketplace launch (Month 6). YouTube content production begins.

10.3 Success Criteria (Year 1)

- 8,000+ monthly active users on the platform
- 400+ paying subscribers (skills library + video access)
- 50+ tutoring sessions facilitated through the marketplace
- Full GCSE coverage (all subjects, all major exam boards)
- £25K+ total revenue
- Positive user feedback and organic word-of-mouth growth

10.4 What Comes After

If the pilot succeeds, Year 2 focuses on scale: full A-Level coverage, news curation expansion, mobile app consideration, school partnerships (B2B), and hiring a content editor and marketing lead. Year 3 introduces the academic simplification pillar fully and explores international GCSE / IB markets.

If the pilot struggles, the fallback is to focus exclusively on GCSE/A-Level revision (the most proven market) and drop the other pillars until the core product has traction. The skills library can spin off as a separate product if it shows independent demand.